

Emirates Advertising Awards 2026 — Submission Brief

Confidential — Submission for Emirates Advertising Awards 2026 · Category: Integrated Tourism Campaign

Client: Dubai Tourism & Commerce Marketing (DTCM)

Project: See Dubai Differently — Multichannel Campaign

Submission Category: Integrated Marketing Campaign — Tourism

Background

Dubai Tourism appointed Seekra Creative in March 2026 to develop and execute an integrated marketing campaign targeting millennial and Gen Z travelers from GCC, Europe, and South Asia. The campaign objective was to reposition Dubai beyond luxury shopping — surfacing the city creative, heritage, and adventure experiences.

The campaign launched on 1 June 2026 across TV, digital, out-of-home, and experiential channels, running through 31 August 2026 (peak summer season).

Creative Strategy

The strategic insight: Dubai is the only city where you can surf at dawn, ride a horse through a desert sunset, and edit a film at midnight — all in the same day, all within 45 minutes of each other.

We named this See Dubai Differently — a campaign built around three ordinary people discovering three extraordinary versions of the city: the surfer, the rider, the editor.

Execution

Three 60-second hero films, each centered on one character. Cross-cut between their activity and the city that enables it. Director: Nora Al Suwaidi. DP: Marco Beltrami. Shot across Dubai: Kite Beach, Al Marmoom Desert, Alserkal Avenue.

300+ digital assets derived from the hero films: 15s and 30s cutdowns, vertical 9:16 for TikTok/Reels, square for Instagram feed, 1920x1080 for YouTube pre-roll.

Experiential: pop-up photo installations at The Dubai Mall, City Walk, and Alserkal Avenue during July 2026 — over 47,000 visitor interactions measured.

Results

Reach: 23.4M unique individuals across all channels (target: 18M).

Engagement: 4.2M video completions (target: 2.5M). 68% above benchmark.

Sentiment: 91% positive/neutral across social listening (benchmark: 78%).

Visit impact: Dubai visitor arrivals in Jul-Aug 2026 were 14% higher year-over-year (DTCM official statistics, partial attribution).

Brand lift: Dubai = creative city association rose from 31% to 47% in target markets.

Budget & ROI

Total campaign budget: AED 6.8M (creative production + media buy + experiential).

Cost per completed view: AED 1.62 (industry benchmark: AED 2.40).

Estimated tourism revenue impact: AED 340M+ (DTCM econometric model).

Why This Deserves to Win

This campaign did not sell Dubai — it let Dubai sell itself, by surfacing the authentic creative pulse that 90% of tourists never see. It moved the brand from luxury to creativity without abandoning luxury. It delivered above benchmark on every measurable metric. And it was made in Dubai, by Dubai talent, for a global audience — which is exactly what the Emirates Advertising Awards exist to celebrate.

Agency	Seekra Creative (Mohammed Al Marri, CEO)
Client	Dubai Tourism & Commerce Marketing
Campaign	See Dubai Differently
Total Budget	AED 6.8M
ROI	AED 340M+ tourism impact